

Chapter 11 — Viśva-Rūpa-Darśana Yoga

विश्वरूपदर्शनयोगः : विश्वरూपादర్शनयोगम्

"The Vision of the Cosmic Form" · 55 verses · The most dramatic chapter of the Gītā

Arjuna asks the unaskable: *"If You really are everything — let me see it."*

Kṛṣṇa grants him **divine eyes** (*divya-caṅśus*) and reveals His **Viśva-Rūpa** — the all-encompassing cosmic form.

Arjuna sees infinite faces, infinite arms, the sun and moon as eyes, all gods, all worlds, all time pouring forth and being devoured. He is overwhelmed with terror and ecstasy, and finally begs to see the gentle human form again.

This chapter contains **BG 11.32** — the verse Oppenheimer quoted at the moment of the first atomic explosion.

Essential verses of Chapter 11

BG 11.12 *If a thousand suns rose at once — that would resemble His splendor*

दिवि सूर्यसहस्रस्य भवेद्युगपदुत्थिता ।

यदि भाः सदृशी सा स्याद्भासस्तस्य महात्मनः ॥ ११.१२ ॥

దివి సూర్యసహస్రస్య భవేద్యుగపదుత్థితా ।

యది భాః సదృశీ సా స్యాద్భాసస్తస్య మహాత్మనః ॥ ౧౧.౧౨ ॥

divi sūrya-sahasrasya bhaved yugapad utthitā |

yadi bhāḥ sadṛśī sā syād bhāsas tasya mahātmanah | |

"If the radiance of a thousand suns

were to rise in the sky at once —

that might resemble the splendor of that mighty One."

This is the verse Oppenheimer thought of first, on July 16, 1945.

BG 11.32 *"I am Time, destroyer of worlds" — the verse Oppenheimer actually quoted*

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

कालोऽस्मि लोकक्षयकृत्प्रवृद्धो

लोकान्समार्हतुमिह प्रवृत्तः ।

ऋतेऽपि त्वां न भविष्यन्ति सर्वे

येऽवस्थिताः प्रत्यनीकेषु योधाः ॥ ११.३२ ॥

శ్రీభగవానువాచ ।

కాలోఽస్మి లోకక్షయకృత్ప్రవృద్ధో

లోకాన్సమాహర్తుమిహ ప్రవృత్తః ।

ఋతేఽపి త్వాం న భవిష్యంతి సర్వే

యేఽవస్థితాః ప్రత్యనీకేషు యోధాః ॥ ౧౧.౩౨ ॥

śrī-bhagavān uvāca |

kālo 'smi loka-kṣaya-kṛt pravṛddho

lokān samāhartum iha pravṛttaḥ |

ṛte 'pi tvāṁ na bhaviṣyanti sarve

ye 'vasthitāḥ praty-anīkeṣu yodhāḥ | |

"The Blessed Lord said:

I am Time, the mighty destroyer of worlds —

here come forth to annihilate the worlds.

Even without you, none of these warriors arrayed in the opposing armies shall live."

✦ Word-by-Word — 11.32 (kālo'smi)

IAST	कालः अस्मि	कालः अस्मि	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>kālaḥ asmi</i>	कालः अस्मि	कालः अस्मि	KAA-lah AS-mi	I am Time
<i>loka-kṣaya-kṛt</i>	लोकक्षयकृत्	लोकक्षयकृत्	LO-ka-KSHA-ya-krit	the destroyer of worlds
<i>pravṛddhaḥ</i>	प्रवृद्धः	प्रवृद्धः	pra-VRID-dhah	grown mighty, fully grown
<i>lokān</i>	लोकान्	लोकान्	lo-KAAN	the worlds
<i>samāhartum</i>	समाहर्तुम्	समाहर्तुम्	sa-MAA-har-tum	to annihilate, to gather up
<i>iha</i>	इह	इह	I-ha	here
<i>pravṛttaḥ</i>	प्रवृत्तः	प्रवृत्तः	pra-VRIT-tah	engaged, set in motion
<i>rte api tvām</i>	ऋते अपि त्वाम्	ऋते अपि त्वाम्	RI-te A-pi tvaam	even without you
<i>na bhaviṣyanti sarve</i>	न भविष्यन्ति सर्वे	न भविष्यन्ति सर्वे	na bha-VISH-yan-ti SAR-ve	none shall remain
<i>avasthitāḥ</i>	अवस्थिताः	अवस्थिताः	a-vas-THI-taah	arrayed, positioned
<i>praty-anīkeṣu</i>	प्रत्यनीकेषु	प्रत्यनीकेषु	prat-ya-NEE-ke-shu	in the opposing armies
<i>yodhāḥ</i>	योधाः	योधाः	YO-dhaah	warriors

BG 11.55 The closing verse — the formula for reaching the Lord

मत्कर्मकृन्मत्परमो मद्भक्तः सङ्गवर्जितः ।

निर्वैरः सर्वभूतेषु यः स मामेति पाण्डव ॥ ११.५५ ॥

మత్కర్మకృన్మత్పరమో మద్భక్తః సంగవర్జితః ।

నిర్వైరః సర్వభూతేషు యః స మామేతి పాండవ ॥ ౧౧.౫౫ ॥

mat-karma-kṛn mat-paramo mad-bhaktaḥ saṅga-varjitaḥ |

nirvairaḥ sarva-bhūteṣu yaḥ sa mām eti pāṇḍava ||

"One who does My work, considers Me supreme, is devoted to Me,
is free from attachment, free of enmity toward all beings —
that one comes to Me, O Pāṇḍava."

The five-fold formula: *do God's work, hold God supreme, be devoted, unattached, friendly to all.*

□ Essential take-away of Chapter 11

God is unimaginably vast — and that vastness is terrifying.

But the same Lord who is Time devouring all worlds is also the gentle friend on the chariot. Arjuna's plea after seeing the cosmic form — "*Please show me the four-armed form again, the gentle face I love*" — teaches us something profound: **the personal Divine is not less than the cosmic — it is the same, lovingly veiled.**

We need both: **awe at the vastness** and **tenderness with the near.**